Day 21 - Vanderleck, Al Shaw, Cliff Hatch, Speyside South, 17 Sideroad, Hilton Falls

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 28 · Speyside area

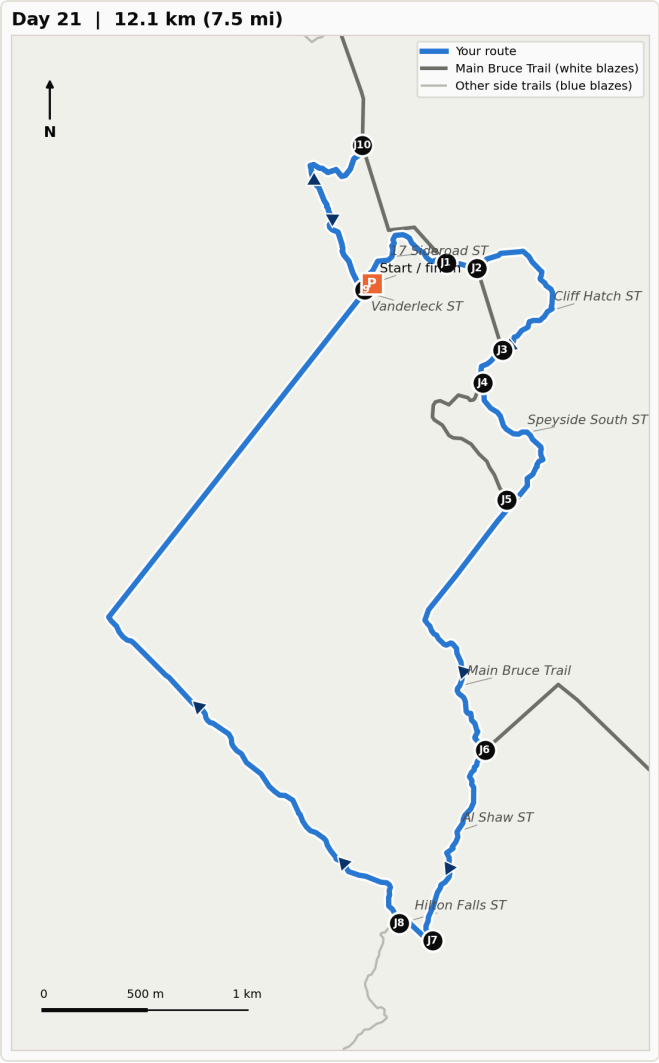
12.1 km / 7.5 mi	~3.4 h	9.2 km new	41 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Roadside parking on 17 Sideroad, 730 m northeast of Halton Rd 25. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day21_hike028.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Vanderleck Side Trail (5.4 km); Al Shaw Side Trail (1.1 km); Cliff Hatch Side Trail (1.0 km); Speyside South Side Trail (0.9 km); 17 Sideroad Side Trail (0.7 km); Hilton Falls Side Trail (0.2 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on 17 Sideroad, 730 m northeast of Halton Rd 25. Pull fully off the road.
- **Vanderleck Side Trail:** A hiking club's description of the Vanderleck loop mentions variable terrain, rocky sections and a fine lookout.
- **Main trail near Speyside:** The Bruce Trail passes through the small community of Speyside, home to the Royal Oak, a heritage tree planted by local schoolchildren for the 1937 coronation of King George VI.
- **Road walking:** Parts of the Vanderleck Side Trail and the main trail follow a road shoulder; keep Zappy close and walk single file facing traffic.
- **Short connectors:** No descriptions were found for the Al Shaw, Cliff Hatch, 17 Sideroad, Speyside South or Hilton Falls connector trails. Follow the blue blazes and the guide's directions.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on 17 Sideroad, 730 m northeast of Halton Rd 25. Walk about 30 m to the trail. Head north-west on the blue-blazed 17 Sideroad Side Trail.
0.6	0.4	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
0.8	0.5	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Cliff Hatch Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.1	0.7	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).

1.8	1.1	J3: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.0	1.2	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Speyside South Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.7	1.7	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
2.8	1.8	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.9	1.8	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.4	2.7	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Al Shaw Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
5.4	3.4	J7: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Hilton Falls Side Trail, heading west. The next 0.2 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
5.6	3.5	J8: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Vanderleck Side Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Hilton Falls Side Trail goes off ahead.)
6.5	4.0	Heads-up: The next 1.4 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
7.8	4.9	Heads-up: The next 2.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
9.9	6.1	J9: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Vanderleck Side Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed 17 Sideroad Side Trail goes off ahead.)
11.0	6.8	J10: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
12.1	7.5	J9: Turn left onto the blue-blazed 17 Sideroad Side Trail, heading north-east. (the Vanderleck Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.) The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
12.1	7.5	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Guelph Hiking Trail Club and Hiking the GTA.